MESA SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Data Foundations · Pre-Read

Session 7: Lenskart

Big Mastery Question: Offline or online — where does the next Rs 5 Cr of store investment go? One table, one chart, 90 seconds.

Before you come to class

Read this once, slowly. Everything up to now has been formulas. This session is different — pivot tables, charts and conditional formatting are mostly MENU-DRIVEN, not typed. The goal isn't memorizing clicks; it's understanding what each tool is FOR, so in class you can build the right one fast. Every table below still shows real column letters and row numbers where relevant.

The company: Lenskart sells eyewear both online and through physical stores across India. Every order records the channel (online or offline), the city, the frame category and how much it earned. Your job this session: summarize thousands of orders into one clear table and one clear chart, fast enough to make the case for where the next round of store investment should go.

0. The Dataset You'll Be Working With

Lenskart's orders table has 10 columns (order_id, order_date, channel, city, store_id, frame_category, lens_type, units, order_value, customer_type). Here's a 6-column, 6-row slice:

	A	C	D	F	H	I
1	order_id	channel	city	frame_category	units	order_value
2	LK7001	Online	Bengaluru	Sunglasses	1	2200
3	LK7002	Offline	Bengaluru	Eyeglasses	1	3500
4	LK7003	Online	Mumbai	Eyeglasses	2	6200
5	LK7004	Offline	Delhi	Sunglasses	1	1800
6	LK7005	Online	Bengaluru	Eyeglasses	1	3100
7	LK7006	Offline	Mumbai	Sunglasses	1	2000

Column A = order_id, C = channel, D = city, F = frame_category, H = units, I = order_value. (B = order_date, E = store_id, G = lens_type, J = customer_type, not shown.)

1. What a Pivot Table Is

Real world reference:

Imagine dumping a huge box of mixed LEGO bricks on the table and asking a friend to sort them into neat piles by color, then tell you how many bricks are in each pile — without you touching a single brick yourself. A pivot table is exactly that sorting friend, built into Sheets.

In Lenskart's world:

You could build "total revenue by city" using SUMIF, one city at a time, by hand. Or you could point a pivot table at the whole orders sheet and get every city's total — AND every channel's total, AND every combination of the two — instantly, in one summary grid, with zero formulas typed.

How to do it:

```
Select your data → Insert → Pivot table → choose "New sheet" → Create
```

See it in the table:

From the 6-row sample above, a pivot table summarizing revenue by city takes seconds to build and looks like this:

	A	B
1	city	SUM of order_value
2	Bengaluru	8800
3	Mumbai	8200
4	Delhi	1800

Three raw rows of Bengaluru data (2200+3500+3100) became one number — 8800 — automatically. That's the entire point of a pivot table.

2. Rows, Columns, Values & Filters

Real world reference:

Think of sorting a stack of mail into a cubby shelf: ROWS might be "which street," COLUMNS might be "which apartment number," and VALUES is what you actually count sitting in each cubby — like how many letters. A FILTER is like deciding "only show me mail addressed to adults" before you even start sorting.

In Lenskart's world:

To compare online vs offline revenue city by city in one grid: drag city into ROWS, channel into COLUMNS, and order_value into VALUES (set to SUM). Add frame_category as a FILTER if you only want to study, say, Eyeglasses.

How to do it:

```
In the Pivot table editor, drag fields into each zone: Rows → city   Columns → channel   Values → order_value (SUM)   Filters → frame_category
```

See it in the table:

	A	B	C
1	city	Offline	Online
2	Bengaluru	3500	5300
3	Mumbai	2000	6200
4	Delhi	1800	0

Rows (city) run down the left, Columns (channel) run across the top, and Values (SUM of order_value) fill the grid — exactly the shape you'd get by dragging those three fields into a real pivot table.

3. Choosing the Right Summary: SUM vs COUNTA vs AVERAGE

Real world reference:

If you tip out a jar of coins onto a table, SUM tells you the total value, COUNTA tells you how many coins there are, and AVERAGE tells you the typical value of one coin. Same jar, three completely different — and equally valid — questions.

In Lenskart's world:

Drop order_value into a pivot's Values zone and Sheets defaults to SUM (total revenue) — but click the dropdown and you can switch it to COUNTA (how many orders) or AVERAGE (average order value). Picking the wrong one gives a technically-correct but misleading answer — like reporting "average revenue per city" when the founder actually asked for total revenue.

How to do it:

```
In the Values zone of the pivot editor, click "SUM of order_value" → Summarize by → choose SUM, COUNTA, or AVERAGE
```

See it in the table:

	A	B	C	D
1	**city**	**SUM (revenue)**	**COUNTA (orders)**	**AVERAGE (AOV)**
2	Bengaluru	8800	3	2933
3	Mumbai	8200	2	4100

Same underlying data, three different pivot configurations, three genuinely different (and all correct) answers to three different questions.

4. % of Row / Column

Real world reference:

Instead of saying "this slice of pizza weighs 120 grams," it's often more useful to say "this slice is 25% of the whole pizza" — same information, but instantly comparable to slices from a completely different-sized pizza.

In Lenskart's world:

Raw revenue numbers make Bengaluru (a bigger city) look automatically more "online-heavy" than Delhi just because it has more total orders. Switching the Values display to "% of Row" instead shows what SHARE of each city's revenue is online vs offline — a fair comparison regardless of city size.

How to do it:

```
In the Values zone → click "SUM of order_value" → Show as → % of row
```

See it in the table:

	A	B	C	D	E
1	**city**	**Offline (raw)**	**Online (raw)**	**Offline (% of row)**	**Online (% of row)**
2	Bengaluru	3500	5300	40%	60%
3	Mumbai	2000	6200	24%	76%

Mumbai looks even MORE online-skewed than Bengaluru once you look at the percentages — a pattern the raw revenue numbers alone made harder to see clearly.

5. Grouping Dates in a Pivot

Real world reference:

Like sorting your phone's photos not by the exact date each one was taken, but by which MONTH — a much more useful bucket for spotting a trend.

In Lenskart's world:

Drop order_date straight into a pivot's Rows and you'll get one row per exact date — far too granular to see a trend. Right-click any date in the pivot and group it by Month, and Sheets automatically buckets every order into its month, doing behind the scenes exactly what EOMONTH did manually back in Session 6.

How to do it:

```
In the pivot, right-click any date cell in Rows → "Create pivot date group" → Month
```

See it in the table:

	A	B
1	**Month**	**SUM of order_value**
2	Jun 2026	142000
3	Jul 2026	168500

6. Choosing the Right Chart

Real world reference:

A ruler measures length; a weighing scale measures weight. You wouldn't use one for the other's job. Charts work the same way — each type is built to answer a specific KIND of question, and using the wrong one makes even correct data look confusing or misleading.

In Lenskart's world:

"Compare revenue across 5 cities" is a COMPARISON question — a column chart. "How has revenue trended over the last 6 months" is a TREND question — a line chart. "How does online vs offline revenue break down within each city" is a PART-OF-A-WHOLE question — a stacked column chart. Picking the right one is what makes your 90-second chart land instantly.

How to do it:

```
Select your summary table → Insert → Chart → choose the chart type in the editor's Setup tab
```

See the decision guide:

	A	B
1	**Your question**	**Best chart**
2	Compare a few categories side by side	Column chart
3	Show a trend over time	Line chart
4	Show parts making up a whole, across categories	Stacked column chart
5	Show the relationship between two numeric variables	Scatter chart

One common mistake to avoid: never use a line chart for categories that have no real order (like cities) — lines imply a trend, and cities don't have one.

7. Conditional Formatting

Real world reference:

Think of a traffic light that turns red automatically the moment too many cars pile up — nobody has to sit there watching and manually flip a switch. Conditional formatting is that automatic traffic light for your spreadsheet: cells change color BY THEMSELVES the moment a rule is met.

In Lenskart's world:

Instead of scanning a table of 30 stores by eye to spot underperformers, set a rule: any store with revenue below ₹2,000 turns red automatically. The moment new data comes in, the color updates itself — no manual re-checking, ever.

How to do it:

```
Select the range → Format → Conditional formatting → Format rules: "Less than" → 2000 → choose a red fill → Done
```

See it in the table:

	A	B
1	**city**	**SUM of order_value**
2	Bengaluru	8800
3	Mumbai	8200
4	Delhi	1800

Delhi is automatically shaded because 1800 is below the 2000 threshold — nobody typed that color in; the rule did it, and it will keep doing it as new orders come in.

Coming to class

You now know what a pivot table does, how to pick the right chart, and how to make cells flag problems automatically. In class, we'll build the real revenue-by-channel-by-city pivot, chart it, and make the 90-second case for where Lenskart's next stores should go.